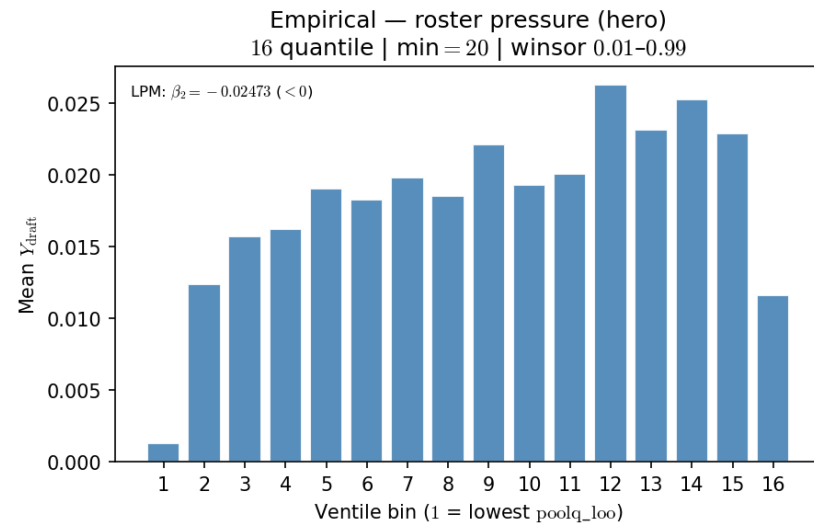
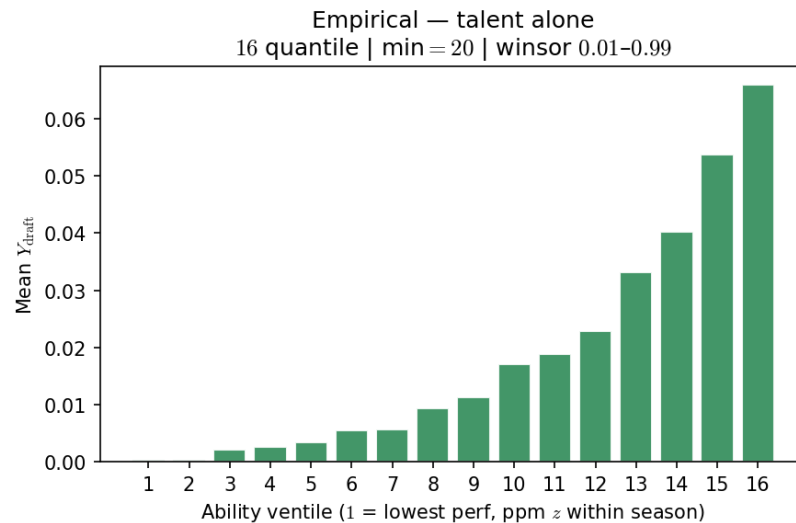


Pass A — Empirical MBB: Roster Pressure in the Data

Pass A — Empirical MBB: talent read vs roster-pressure read
Qualitative shapes only; no bin-for-bin claim to generative sim



Real NCAA panel (2011–2021): mean NBA draft rate by ventile.

Left — talent alone: ability (ppm z within season). Monotone up.

Right — roster context: leave-one-out teammate quality ($\text{poolq}|_{\text{loo}}$). Inverted-U.

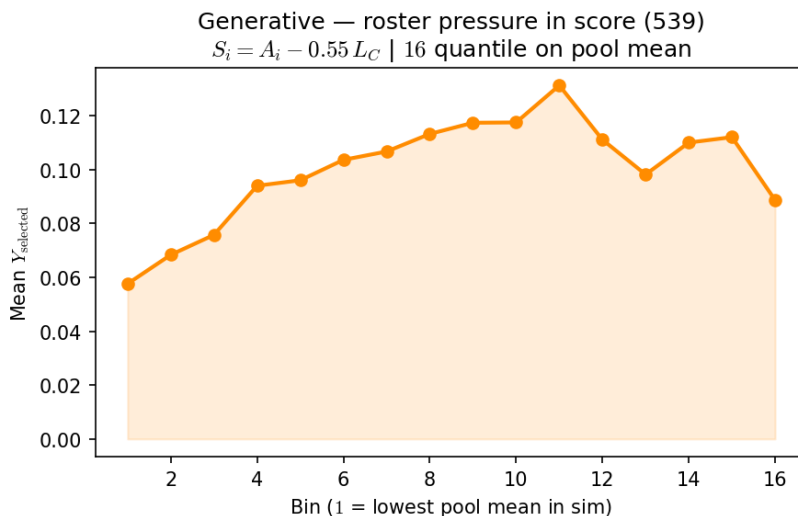
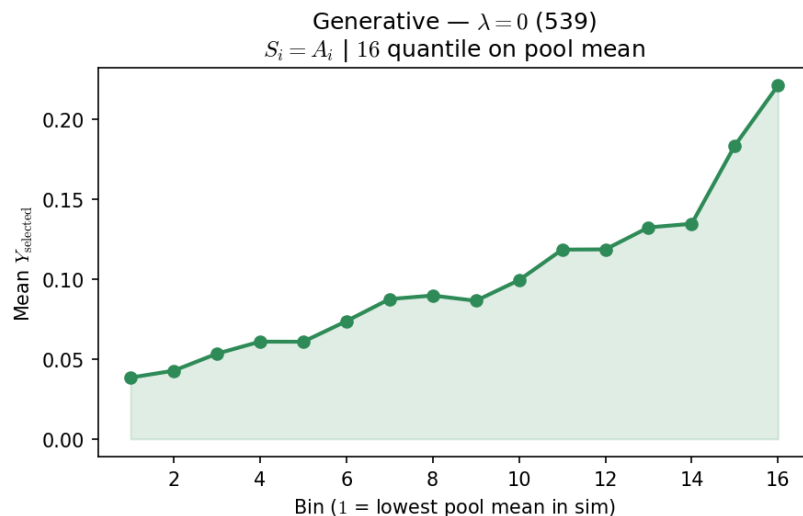
No λ in the empirical story — stylized fact Pass B/C echo.

Pipeline: VISUALIZE only (bin real Y_{draft} on ability | $\text{poolq}|_{\text{loo}}$).

Assign → Score → Select in the real world; we read outcomes only.

Pass B — Generative: Congestion in Score Bends the Curve

Pass B — Generative league: λ off vs λ on in SCORE
Readout binned on pool mean (not $poolq_{loo}$); qualitative POC

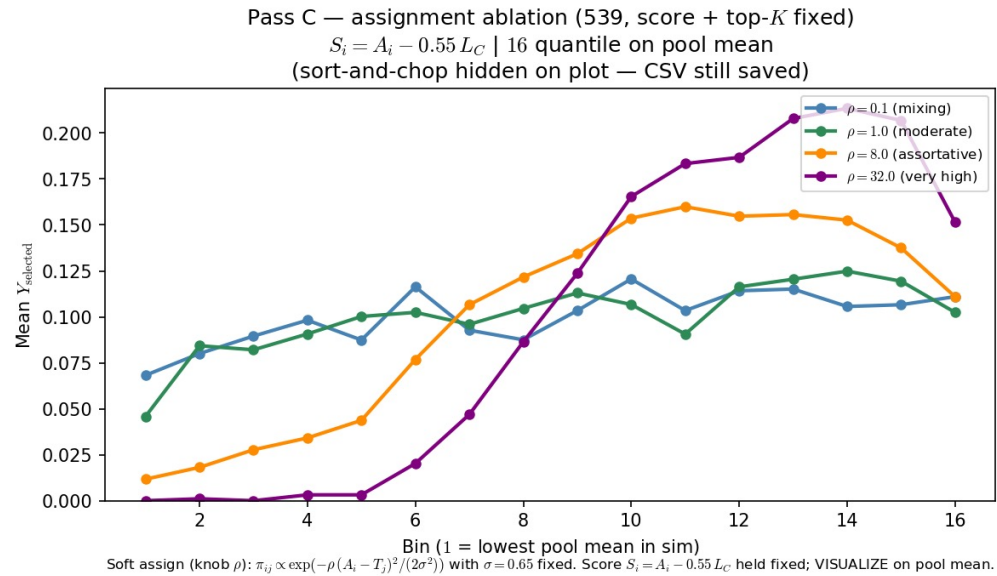


Synthetic league: ASSIGN → SCORE → SELECT → VISUALIZE (539 preset).
Left — $\lambda = 0$: score $S_i = A_i$ only (talent-only ranking). Roughly monotone.
Right — $\lambda > 0$: score $S_i = A_i - w|,LC$ (viable-peer congestion in SCORE).

VISUALIZE on pool mean (team ability, includes self) — not $poolq_{loo}$.
Claim: roster pressure in the advancement rule bends the curve (qualitative POC).

Pass B knob: λ / w in SCORE. Does not vary assignment ρ .

Pass C — Generative: Assortativity Shapes the Sorted World



Same 539 score as Pass B right arm — $S_i = A_i - w|, LC$ held fixed.
 One draw of talent; only ASSIGN changes (soft ρ ladder + sort-and-chop).
 ρ controls how sharply players match team targets — roster sorting.

VISUALIZE on pool mean: assortativity moves the inverted-U readout.
 Story: λ puts roster pressure in score; ρ delivers pressured environments.

Pass C knob: ρ in ASSIGN. Score + top- K fixed across arms.